

Lesson 14

Conflict Resolution Strategies



Warm-Up

Discussion:

1. How did you usually resolve work conflicts?
2. What have you **learned** from past workplace conflicts?
3. Do you think conflict can **help people grow or work better**? Why or why not?



Role-Play

***Scenario 1:** Two team members, Anna and Michael, must decide who will present at the next client meeting.*

Anna: Hi Michael, I see both our names are down to present at the client meeting. I was looking forward to doing it, but I know you were too.

Michael: That's right. I'd like to present as well. **What would be a fair solution? Maybe we can find a middle ground?**

Anna: Good idea. How about we both give a little? We could split the presentation so each of us has a part.

Michael: I like that suggestion. **I'm willing to adjust if you are, too.**

Anna: Yes, **let's meet halfway** and share the presentation.

Michael: Great, let's discuss our parts and make sure it's smooth.

Scenario 2: Two team leaders, Maria and Henry, are deciding how to allocate a limited budget between their projects.

Maria: Henry, the budget is very tight this quarter, but both our projects are important. **Let's work together to find a solution.**

Henry: I was thinking the same. **How can we both get what we want?**

Maria: Maybe **we can combine our ideas to make it work for both of us.** If we adjust our timelines, maybe each project can get what it needs most right now.

Henry: That makes sense. **What if we try to satisfy both sides and look for ways to share resources too?**

Maria: Good idea. **Let's brainstorm options together** and create a proposal for management.

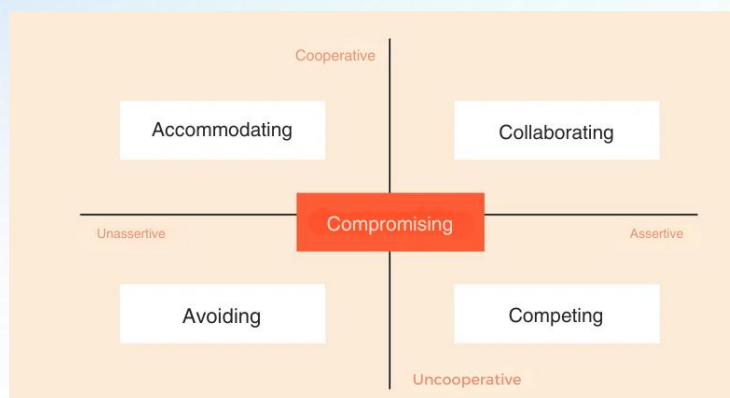
Henry: Perfect. I'm confident **we can find a way that fits both teams.**

Role-play Analysis

1. What are the main problems in each dialogue?
2. How do the speakers show respect for each other's ideas and needs in these dialogues?



Conflict Resolution Strategies



Strategies	Definitions
1. Avoiding	Ignoring or postponing the conflict instead of addressing it.
2. Accommodating	Putting others' needs before your own and giving in to their preferences.
3. Competing	Trying to win the conflict with your own needs, with little regard for others.
4. Compromising	Both sides give up something to reach a mutual agreement.
5. Collaborating	Working together to find a solution that fully satisfies everyone's needs.



Pronunciation

Practice pronouncing these words with the correct stress:

1. com**P**eting /kəm'pi:tɪŋ/
2. ac**CO**mmodating /ə'kɒmədeɪtɪŋ/
3. a**VO**iding /ə'vɔɪdɪŋ/
4. a**CO**mpromising /kɒmpremaɪzɪŋ/
5. coll**A**borating /kə'læbəreɪtɪŋ/



Practice

Match following phrases with their relevant conflict resolution strategies:

Strategies

1. Competing

2. Accommodating

3. Avoiding

4. Compromising

5. Collaborating

Expressions

a. "Maybe we should leave this for now."

b. "I'm happy to go with your idea."

c. "Let's work together to find a solution."

d. "Let's meet halfway."

e. "I don't mind adjusting for you."

f. "I'm willing to adjust if you are, too."

g. "Let's combine our ideas to make it work for both of us."

h. "I strongly recommend we follow my approach."

i. "Maybe we can find a middle ground."



Production

ROLE-PLAY: SOLVING CONFLICTS

Work in pairs or small groups and follow the guidelines for your activity:

1. Choose a scenario for your group and assign roles to each team member.

(For a group of three, one can act as a Mediator)

2. Role-play the scenario.
3. Find the best strategy to resolve the conflicts, using phrases in Practice activity.

Conflict Scenarios

Scenario	A	B
1. Project Deadline	You think the project should be completed by the end of the month to meet the customer's expectations.	You think the deadline is flexible and prefers to focus on the project quality.
	Problem: The disagreement has led to miscommunication, impacting their workflow.	
2. Team Collaboration	The project needs both market research and a client presentation, but it's unclear who does what.	
	Problem: Both of you feel the other is stepping into their preferred responsibilities.	
3. Differences in Work Style	You have a structured, organized approach to projects and prefer to plan every detail well in advance.	You have a more spontaneous and like to leave room for creativity and last-minute changes.
	Problem: As you collaborate on a shared assignment, your differing work styles cause repeated misunderstandings and delays.	

Discussion

1. Which conflict resolution strategy did you find most effective? Why?
2. What challenges arose during your activity?
3. How can you use what you learned today to handle real conflicts at work or in your daily life?